# Psychology

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| **Major** | Psychology<br>心理學 |
| **Degree / Award Title** | Bachelor of Social Sciences in Psychology<br>社會科學學士(心理學) |
| **Offering Academic Unit** | Department of Social and Behavioural Sciences |
| **Mode of Study** | Full-time |

## Aims of Major

The major in Psychology aims at providing students with a comprehensive training in psychology, with emphasis on research competence in the study of human behaviour, for further advancement in professional practice in human and social behavioural services.

**Stream I: Health and Development or Stream II: Mind and Brain (Optional)**
All students, except for students admitted to Stream III: WE-CARE Programme or the Joint Degree Programme with Columbia University, can choose to graduate with a stream by completing at least 4 courses (12 credit units) of the courses listed under the corresponding stream. Each student is only allowed to declare one stream of specialization. The stream will be recorded in the transcript of studies of students upon completion of the degree.

**Stream I: Health and Development**
Aims of Stream
The Health and Development stream provides specialized knowledge and training on well-being, growth and development, and quality of life. The main objective of this stream is to enrich human condition throughout the lifespan. Students will learn about models of assessment, diagnosis, intervention, prevention, and health promotion, with the opportunity for hands-on learning experiences and an emphasis on critical application of learning. The stream is ideal for students who are interested in public health, clinical and health psychology, and human development.

**Stream II: Mind and Brain**
Aims of Stream
The Mind and Brain stream is designed to enrich students' learning and understanding of how our mind works from a brain or neuroscience perspective. The brain imaging and stimulation approaches on studying the human mind, and impact of brain injury on mental function and behaviorual performance will be covered. In addition, hand-on training on experimental design and statistical analysis are included to equip students with the essential skills in the fast-advancing research area. This stream prepares the students who are interested in a future career or academic path in cognitive neuroscience, neuropsychology, psycholinguistics, or in area taking a brain or neuroscience perspective to understand the human mind.

**Stream III: Wellbeing Enhancement and Care Management (WE-CARE) Programme**
Outstanding normative four-year degree students will be enrolled in the stream of Wellbeing Enhancement and Care Management (WE-CARE) Programme at the time of admission to the BSSPSY programme.

The stream will be recorded in the transcript of studies of students. Students who have been admitted to the stream are not eligible to apply for admission to the Joint Degree Programme with Columbia University. Students are required to complete the Stream core courses (9 credit units) under Stream III: WE-CARE Programme and a group of Stream elective courses (at least 12 credit units) selecting from one of the two streams: Stream I: Health and Development or Stream II: Mind and Brain.

Aims of Stream

The stream of Wellbeing Enhancement and Care Management (WE-CARE) Programme is designed to nurture talented students' international and intercultural competence and provide them with overseas study or internship opportunities in one of the prestigious universities and organizations worldwide, leading to enhanced global competitiveness and future career success in their own professions. It is intended to equip exceptional psychology students with expertise for establishing cross-cultural research skills and global professional networks, thus enhancing their competitiveness in further studies and in the international job market.

Under extremely exceptional or unforeseeable circumstances, WE-CARE Programme students can take local internship for one semester with strong justifications, which will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

## Intended Learning Outcomes of Major (MILOs)

1. Identify the ethical implications of the study of psychology for human integrity and diversity;
2. Demonstrate systematic knowledge and its scientific underpinning in the core areas of psychology;
3. Use psychological theories and empirical evidence to analyse human behaviour and mental processes scientifically;
4. Construct and conduct a scientific study and produce a systematic presentation of analyses in a professional manner; and
5. Evaluate and make psychological discoveries in a changing social and cultural context.

## Degree Requirements

| **Requirements** | **Normative 4-year Degree** | **Normative 4-year Degree (WE-CARE Programme)#** | **Advanced Standing I** | **Advanced Standing II (Senior-year Entry)** |
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| Gateway Education requirement | 31 credit units | 31 credit units | 22 credit units | 12 credit units |
| College requirement | 6 credit units | 6 credit units | 6 credit units | 0 credit units *(full exemption)* |
| Major requirement | Foundation-year courses @: 9 credit units<br>Core courses: 36 credit units<br>Elective courses: 18 credit units | Foundation-year courses @: 9 credit units<br>Core courses: 36 credit units<br>Stream core courses: 9 credit units<br>Stream elective courses: 12 credit units | Foundation-year courses @: 3 credit units<br>Core courses: 36 credit units<br>Elective courses: 18 credit units | Foundation-year courses @: 0 credit units<br>Core courses: 30 credit units<br>Elective courses: 18 credit units |
| Free electives / Minor (if applicable) | 21 credit units | 18 credit units | 6 credit units | 0 credit units |
| **Minimum Graduation Requirement:** | **121 credit units** | **121 credit units** | **91 credit units** | **60 credit units** |
| **Maximum Credit Units Permitted:** | **144 credit units** | **144 credit units** | **114 credit units** | **84 credit units** |

** For details, please refer to the Curriculum Information Record for Common Requirements.*

*@ Students of second major and students changed to the Major will follow the Advanced Standing I curriculum and will be required to take one designated Foundation-year course, i.e. SS1101 (3 credit units) (only applicable to normative 4-year degree students and students admitted with Advanced Standing I). ASII students will be exempted from the Foundation-year courses.*

*Students taking Psychology as a 2nd major are required to complete all core courses except SS4708 Research Project in Psychology (i.e., 30 credits), and to take 18 credits in elective courses.*

*# Students from other majors are not eligible for admission to the Normative 4-year Degree (WE-CARE Programme) as a second major. Students who have changed their majors to BSSPSY will not be eligible for admission to the Normative 4-year Degree (WE-CARE Programme).*

## Professional Recognition

Holders of this degree with at least a lower second class honours or GPA 3.0 and have successfully completed a list of courses in different areas of psychology stipulated by the Hong Kong Psychological Society (HKPS) shall be eligible to apply for Graduate Membership of the HKPS. Every HKPS membership application is assessed on an individual basis.

## Additional Information

Students are given choice of opting out from the stream of “Wellbeing Enhancement and Care Management (WE-CARE) Programme. Once excited, they are not allowed to be re-admitted to the stream of “Wellbeing Enhancement and Care Management (WE-CARE) Programme ” in later semester or year. Students who wish to opt out must consult the BSSPSY Major Leader for their approval.

## Related Links

Department of Social and Behavioural Sciences

Joint Degree with Columbia University